authentication and Aadhaar-enabled benefits transfers to bank accounts of beneficiaries. The government has decided to initiate direct transfer of subsidy under various social schemes into beneficiaries' bank accounts. The transfer will be enabled through a payments bridge known as Aadhaar Payment Bridge (APB) wherein funds can be transferred into any Aadhaar-enabled bank account on the basis of the Aadhaar number. This eliminates chances of fraud/error in the cash transfer process. The Aadhaar number will be linked to the beneficiary database so that ghosts/ duplicates are weeded out from the beneficiary list.

To make withdrawal of money by the beneficiaries easier and more accessible and friendly, micro ATMs will be set up by banks/ post offices throughout the country in an open manner particularly with the help of SHGs, community service centres (CSCs), post offices, grocery stores, petrol pumps, etc. in rural areas and accessible pockets. This is being done initially in 51 pilot districts across the country from January 1, 2013. Pilots on direct benefit transfer (DBT) have also been successfully conducted in the states of Jharkhand, Tripura, and Maharashtra to transfer monetary benefits related to rural employment, pension, the IAY, and other social welfare schemes. An important pilot is the fair price shops in East Godavari and Hyderabad districts of Andhra Pradesh which are being enabled to carry out online Aadhaar authentication. In another important pilot with oil marketing companies (OMCs) in Mysore, delivery of LPG gas cylinders is being done only after Aadhaar online authentication of customers.

EDUCATION

India which had a bottom-heavy population is now graduating to an economy with middle- heavy population. To reap the benefits of this demographic dividend to the full, India has to provide education to its population through quality education. The Twelfth Plan Approach Paper focuses on teacher training and evaluation and measures to enforce accountability. It also stresses the need to build capacity in secondary schools to absorb the pass- outs from expanded primary enrolments. The